



THE ONE WITH THE FAKE MONICA

AN ESL EXPLORATION OF
PROSPERITY, IDENTITY, AND
RECKLESS GLAMOUR

Written by Adam Chase & Ira Ungerleider / Reimagined for the Jazz Age

THE DECO PLAYBILL



THE FLAPPER

Fake Monica's reckless spending, embassy crashing, and endless partying.



THE ACTOR

Joey's Gatsby-esque quest to shed his ethnicity for a "neutral" stage name.



THE WILD

Marcel's untamable biological nature shattering the illusion of civilized city life.

RECKLESS (adj.)

Doing something without caring about danger.

"It's just such reckless spending!"

ASTOUNDING (adj.)

Surprisingly impressive.

"She is this astounding person, with this amazing spirit."

VIGILANTE (noun)

Someone who takes the law into their own hands.

"Your own brand of vigilante justice."

SHUNNED (verb)

Ignored or rejected by a community.

"Till I bought a blow dryer, then I was shunned."

THE PURITAN: REAL MONICA

✦ **BACKGROUND:**
Pennsylvania Dutch /
Amish-adjacent rigidity.

✦ **LIFESTYLE:**
Fluffs pillows, rolls pennies as
soon as they are in the dish.

✦ **PHILOSOPHY:** Timid.
Intimidated by salespeople.



THE FLAPPER: “MONANA”

✦ **BACKGROUND:**
Worldly. Lived in
Amsterdam, speaks Dutch.

✦ **LIFESTYLE:**
Crashes the St. Regis hotel, takes
tap class, buys \$300 art supplies.

✦ **PHILOSOPHY:** Fearless.
Leaves caution to the wind.





Monica

Vocab: Uncoordinated.
Monica floundering.

Idiom: "It's gym class all over again"
(Experiencing traumatic repetition).

Idiom:

It does not ring a bell. (To sound familiar. Essential conversational phrase for not recognizing the dance steps.)

Rachel

Vocab: Click / In Sync.
Rachel masters the steps perfectly
("I did 42nd Street in college").

The Teacher

Vocab: Spare containers.
Warning students about leaving
empty yogurt cups.



PIPE DREAM

A fantastic but vain hope (e.g., *Getting a monkey into the out-of-state San Diego Zoo*).

LIVE THE DREAM

Experiencing the ideal, lavish life.

THROW CAUTION TO THE WIND

To take a risk and ignore all warnings.

GET A HOLD OF

To acquire or obtain (e.g., *How could someone get a hold of your card number?*).

THE DREAM

Experiments soar (e.g., *focept a sturnisa dorit*).

Cats & Memories

The open call audition Fake Monica suggests they attend.

Wintergarden Theater

The prestigious stage where Monica dreams of singing.

Dead Poets Society vs. Mrs. Doubtfire

Fake Monica's controversial take: the real tragedy wasn't the ending, it was wasting two hours watching a boring movie.

Big Apple Circus

The ultimate symbol of skipping adult responsibilities for childish wonder.

THE GOAL:

A name that is
“neutral” and not
too “ethnic”.

~~Joey
Pepponi~~

~~Joey
Switzerland~~

~~Joe Stalin~~

THE COMEDIC MISUNDERSTANDING:

Chandler’s sarcastic sabotage.
Joey thinks Joseph Stalin is a
star in *Fiddler on the Roof*
or *Bye Bye Birdie*.

THE PAYOFF:

Auditioning for the
role of Mercutio
under the name
“Holden McGroin.”

PHASE

A temporary period
of development.

DOCILE

Calm, tame, and
easy to control.

SEXUAL MATURITY

Reaching adulthood biologically
(triggering new behaviors).

AGGRESSIVE / VICIOUS

Violent, dangerous,
and unpredictable.

INTERACTIVE

Allowing two-way flow of action
(used euphemistically by the sinister vet).

THE GOLD STANDARD

San Diego: The “Safety Zoo”
A Pipe Dream.

THE COMPROMISES

Scranton: Takes “dogs and cows”.
Miami: Two blocks from the beach
“Total party zoo”.

Unpacking the Dark Joke:
An “interactive wildlife experience”
where animals need “small blades”
to fight animals with “horns.”
(*Beastly Bloodsports*).

THE UNDERGROUND

Dr. Baldhara’s Facility.

The Brick Joke: The delay in comedic timing.

The Setup (Scene 5)

Ross: "How do you get a monkey into a zoo?"

Chandler: "I know that one! No, that's Popes into a Volkswagen."

The Payoff (Scene 8)

Phoebe (Out of nowhere):
"Take off their hats! Popes in a Volkswagen... I love that joke."

THE ARREST

The sudden end to the fantasy:
'They've arrested Monica.'

THE CONFRONTATION

The prison scene.
'Fortunately, blue's my color.'

THE REALITY CHECK

Fake Monica's parting wisdom: 'You're gonna go back to being exactly who you were, because that's who you are.'

TAKING THE BRUNT

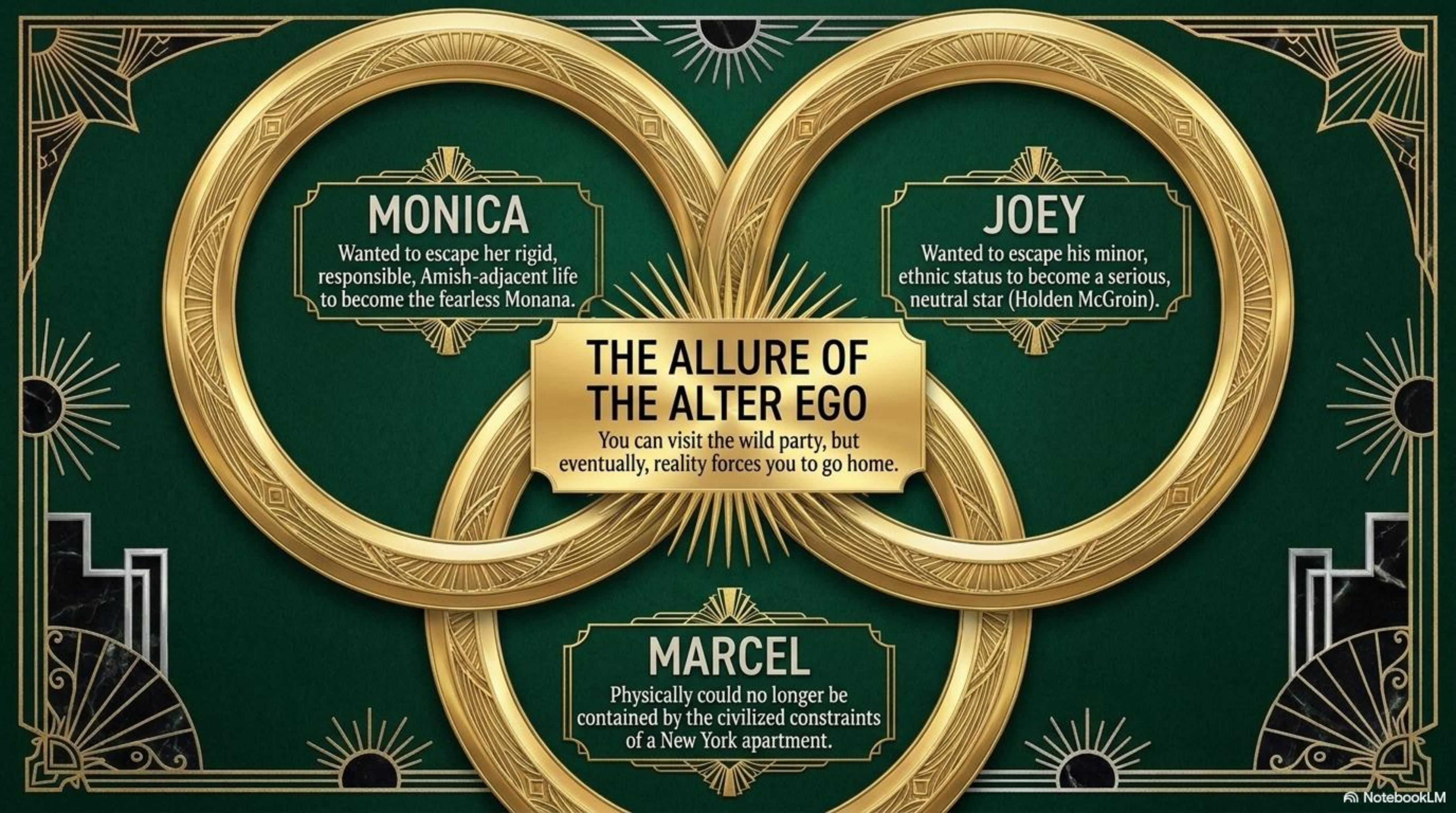
Absorbing the worst part of a situation (e.g., Phoebe observing the chair Ross is sitting on).

CHAMP / BUDDY

Terms of masculine endearment used by Chandler and Ross.

THE SUBVERSION

Ross attempts a touching monologue ("You've been more than just a pet..."), but Marcel ruins the emotion by humping his leg. "Just take him away."



MONICA

Wanted to escape her rigid, responsible, Amish-adjacent life to become the fearless Monana.

JOEY

Wanted to escape his minor, ethnic status to become a serious, neutral star (Holden McGroin).

THE ALLURE OF THE ALTER EGO

You can visit the wild party, but eventually, reality forces you to go home.

MARCEL

Physically could no longer be contained by the civilized constraints of a New York apartment.

Top 5 Vocabulary Words:
Reckless | Astounding | Vigilante
Shunned | Uncoordinated

Top 3 Idioms:

Throw caution to the wind

Live the dream

Pipe dream

Curtain Call. Master the language, master the stage.